

```
parts --report /etc/cron.weekly )
52 6 1 * * root test -x /usr/sbin/anacron || ( cd / && run-
parts --report /etc/cron.monthly )
#
```

As Cron read files from the `/etc/cron.d` directory usually system update manager, log rotation utilities put their Cron jobs in this directory. Users can also copy their Cron tables here. The 'run-parts' command runs scripts in a directory via the `/etc/crontab` file. Table 4 gives additional information about a few more directories.

Table 4

Location	Description
<code>/etc/cron.d</code>	Put required scripts here and call them from <code>/etc/crontab</code>
<code>/etc/cron.daily</code>	'run-parts' executes all scripts once a day
<code>/etc/cron.hourly</code>	'run-parts' executes all scripts once an hour
<code>/etc/cron.monthly</code>	'run-parts' executes all scripts once a month
<code>/etc/cron.weekly</code>	'run-parts' executes all scripts once a week

Though Cron is a great utility, it has some limitations, which are listed below:

- Although a Cron job is executed as the user is executing command(s), it does not source any files from its home directory, like `.bashrc` or `.cshrc`. The user has to do it explicitly.
- If, for a user, the Cron table is defined but the shell entry is not set in the `/etc/passwd` file, then the Cron job will not run.
- For Cron, the smallest possible granularity is a minute. It does not deal with seconds.
- If a Cron job is defined for a particular time interval and the system is not running during that time, then the Cron job is not executed. Anacron is also a task scheduling utility that can handle this situation.

Cron is one of the favourite utilities of a command line junkie. It makes the GNU/Linux system administrator's life much easier. It schedules tasks in the background and starts execution without manual intervention. It provides effective ways to schedule tasks in an automated and repetitive manner. These simple, light-weight command-line utilities make GNU/Linux more powerful and interesting. Isn't Cron an awesome tool?  **END**

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